

USER MANUAL

QR Codes and Link Pages

Create, design and track QR codes and company link pages for Blake UK, VisionPlus and Solwise. Every function, every section, every ability, and exactly what is tracked.



blake 

VISION **PLUS**

Solwise

About this manual

This manual explains everything the QR Codes and Link Pages system does, in the order you are likely to need it. It is built from the Help page inside the system, so the two always say the same thing. If you are signed in, press **Help** in the menu to read the same material on screen.

How each section is written

- **What it is.** What the feature is for, in a sentence or two.
- **How to use it.** The steps, with the exact names of buttons and boxes.
- **What is tracked.** Whether the feature records anything about visitors, and what. Section 4 lists everything in one place.

Conventions

- **Bold** text is the name of a menu item, button or box on screen. *Italic* text is the name of an option.
- `This style` is something you type exactly as shown.
- All names, figures and scans in the screenshots are fictional demonstration data.

Where to start

- New to the system: read section 1, then sections 3 and 4.
- Looking for something specific: use the task finder and the index at the back.
- Worried about privacy: section 4, and Appendix A for the stored fields.

Roles

An **admin** can do everything, including managing users. A **member** can make and manage QR codes, link pages, campaigns and designs, and read all statistics, but cannot manage users. Parts of this manual that only admins can use say so.

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Task finder: I want to...

Find what you are trying to do, then go to the section shown.

Make my first QR code	Section 1: Quick start: your first QR code (page 4)
Choose between a tracked and an untracked code	Section 3: Static or dynamic: which should I choose? (page 5)
See exactly what is recorded about visitors	Section 4: What is tracked, and privacy (page 7)
Put a logo in the middle of a code	Section 7: Designing the look of a code (page 19)
Save a design so I can reuse it	Section 8: How to save and reuse designs (page 20)
Make a code stop after a date	Section 9: Tracking window and what happens at the end (page 22)
Stop a code after 500 scans, or protect it with a password	Section 10: Scan limits and passwords (page 23)
Send iPhone and Android users to different places	Section 11: Sending people to different places (smart routing) (page 24)
Print a code properly and test it	Section 13: Downloading, printing and testing (page 26)
Find out which poster or leaflet works best	Section 16: Campaigns (page 30)
Download scans into a spreadsheet	Section 15: Exporting your data (CSV) (page 29)
Make 200 product codes from a spreadsheet	Section 18: Making many codes at once (bulk) (page 31)
Build a Linktree-style page for Blake UK, VisionPlus or Solwise	Section 19: Link pages (like Linktree) (page 32)
Understand the difference between views and clicks	Section 19: Link pages (like Linktree) (page 32)
Add a colleague, or reset their password	Section 20: Users and roles (page 36)
I am locked out or forgot my password	Section 21: Your account: signing in and your password (page 37)
Check a limit (sizes, lengths, how many)	Section 22: Limits at a glance (page 38)
Something is not working	Section 23: Troubleshooting and questions (page 39)

1. Quick start: your first QR code

What it is. The shortest route to a working, tracked QR code.

1. Press **New QR code** in the menu.
2. Choose **Dynamic (tracked)** and **Website link**.
3. Give it a **Name** (for example "Autumn leaflet") and a **Campaign** (for example "Leaflet").
4. Paste the web address you want people to reach, starting with `https://`.
5. Look at the preview on the right. Change the colours or add your logo if you like.
6. Press **Create QR code**.
7. On the page that opens, download the picture: **SVG** for printing, **PNG** for documents and screens.
8. **Scan it with a phone** before you print anything. Check it opens the right page.
9. Come back to this code's page at any time to see how many people have scanned it.

2. The Codes page

What it is. A list of every QR code, newest first. It is the page you land on after signing in.

How to use it.

- **Name:** click it to open the code, download it, edit it and see its statistics.
- **Type** and the green *dynamic* or grey *static* badge show what kind of code it is.
- **Campaign:** click one to show only the codes in that campaign. Press *clear* to see everything again.
- **Short URL:** the tracking address inside a dynamic code. Static codes do not have one.
- **Destination:** where a scan goes, with a friendly name such as Facebook or "Blake UK website".
- **Window:** *scheduled* (not started yet), *active* (counting now) or *ended* (no longer counting, though the code may still work), with the dates.
- **Scans** and **Unique:** how many scans and how many different visitors. Bots are not counted. See [Reading the statistics](#).
- With more than 25 codes the list is split into pages; use *Newer* and *Older* at the bottom.

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Tracked links (10)

New QR code

▼ What is this? How do I use it?

What it is. Every QR code you have made, newest first. Each row shows its type, whether it is static (untracked) or dynamic (tracked), its campaign, where it sends people and how many times it has been scanned.

How to use it. Click a name to open the code, download it and see its statistics. Click a campaign to show only that campaign. Make a new one with New QR code. [Read more in Help](#)

What is tracked. Nothing about visitors is recorded by this page. The scan counts come from visits to dynamic codes; static codes are never tracked. [Full list](#)

NAME	TYPE	CAMPAIGN	SHORT URL	DESTINATION	WINDOW	SCANS	UNIQUE	LAST SCAN
QR for VisionPlus Official Links	Website link Dynamic	Link pages	https://qr.blakegroup.uk/r/cBLG7IVM	Blake Group website https://qr.blakegroup.uk/l/visionplus-li...	Active 09 Oct 12:30 to 09 Oct 12:30	192	126	09 Oct 2026 18:11
Thank-you message	Plain text Static	Reception	none (not tracked)	holds its content	-	-	-	untracked
Reception Wi-Fi	Wi-Fi network Static	Reception	none (not tracked)	holds its content	-	-	-	untracked
Sales contact card	Contact card (vCard) Dynamic	Trade counter	https://qr.blakegroup.uk/r/xoQ5dGXl	document	Active 09 Oct 12:30 to 07 Jan 11:30	0	0	never
Smart routing example	Smart URL Dynamic	Exhibition stand	https://qr.blakegroup.uk/r/...	Blake UK website https://www.blake-uk.com/	Active 09 Oct 12:30 to 07 Jan 11:30	153	112	09 Oct 2026 20:00

Figure 1. The Codes page: every QR code, with its type, campaign, destination, window and scan counts.

3. Static or dynamic: which should I choose?

What it is. The one big choice you make for every code, and it cannot be changed afterwards.

	Dynamic (tracked)	Static
What the picture contains	A short address on this system. Scans pass through it and are then sent on.	The content itself (the web address, the Wi-Fi details, the contact card...).
Counts and analyses scans	Yes	No: scans never reach this system.
What is recorded about each scan	Time, approximate place, device, system, browser, language, where sent, referring site name and a scrambled visitor token (full list: What is tracked)	Nothing at all
Change where it goes after printing	Yes, any time	No, never. Make a new code.
Start and end dates, scan limit, password, smart routing	Yes	No
Works without internet and without this system	No: it needs this system to be running	Yes, for ever

	Dynamic (tracked)	Static
The picture	Simple and easy to scan, because the address is short	Denser if the content is long

Rule of thumb. Anything for marketing, packaging or print that you want to measure or might need to fix:

dynamic. Wi-Fi, a fixed message or a contact card that will never change and must always work: **static.** If you are unsure, choose dynamic.

Some types are only possible one way. **Wi-Fi and Plain text are static only** (the phone is not online yet when it scans a Wi-Fi code). **App stores and Smart URL are dynamic only** (they need this system to decide where to send each person). The chooser only offers combinations that work.

You cannot turn a static code into a dynamic one later, because the content is already printed inside the picture.

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Sign out (admin)


New QR code

▼ What is this? How do I use it?

What it is. The first step of making a QR code. A dynamic code is tracked and can be changed after printing. A static code holds its content itself, is never tracked, and works for ever.

How to use it. Read the comparison, then click a type. If you are unsure, choose dynamic and Website link: it is the most flexible.
[Read more in Help](#)

What is tracked. A dynamic code records each scan: time, approximate place, device, language and a scrambled visitor token. A static code records nothing. [Full list](#)

Static or dynamic?

	DYNAMIC (TRACKED)	STATIC
Counts scans and shows where, when and on what device	Yes	No
Change where it goes after it is printed	Yes	No, never
Start/end dates, scan limit, password, smart routing	Yes	No
Works offline and keeps working if this service is ever switched off	No, it needs this service	Yes, forever
Best for	Marketing: leaflets, packaging, exhibition stands	Wi-Fi, plain text, contact cards, anything that never changes

A static code cannot be turned into a dynamic one later: the content is printed inside the code. If in doubt, choose dynamic.

Dynamic (tracked) codes

Figure 2. New QR code: choose a dynamic (tracked) or static (untracked) code, then a type.

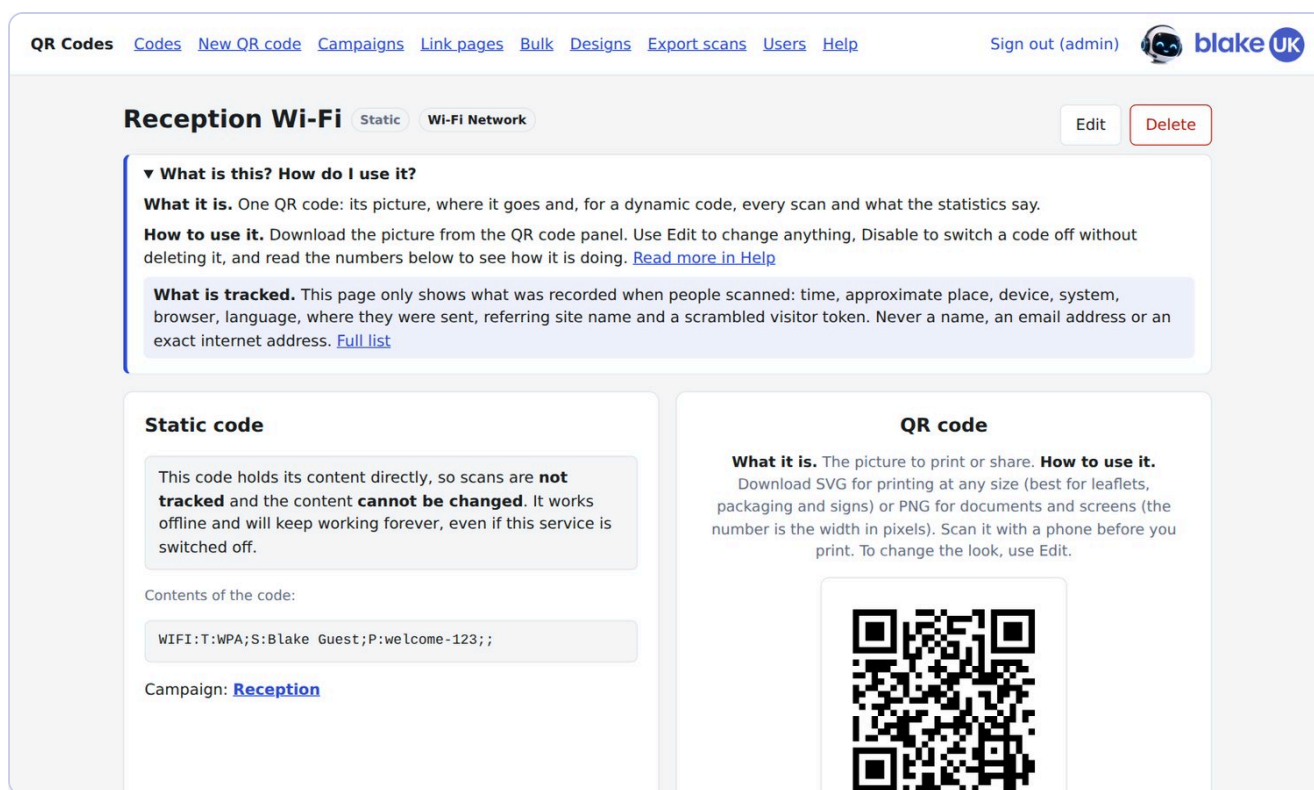


Figure 3. A static code's page says plainly that it is not tracked and cannot be changed.

4. What is tracked, and privacy

What it is. A plain list of everything this system records about people, feature by feature, so nobody has to guess. It is built from the same description the system is tested against, and it is repeated in the PDF manual.

In short

- A **dynamic** QR code records each scan. A **static** QR code records **nothing**.
- A **link page** records each view and each press of a web button. Email and phone buttons are not recorded.
- No names, no email addresses, no tracking cookies and nothing the visitor types. (The only cookie a visitor can ever receive is a 30-minute security token on the password page of a protected code; it holds nothing about them.)
- The visitor's internet address is **not stored**. It is used for a moment to estimate the place and to make a scrambled token, then thrown away.
- Records are deleted automatically after **365 days**.
- Everyone who is signed in can see the statistics and download exports. Visitors can see nothing.

Feature by feature

Someone scans a dynamic QR code

Recorded	The exact time. Which code and campaign. Where that visitor was sent. An approximate country, region and town (worked out from their internet address). Device type, operating system and browser name. Their language setting. The name of the website or app they came from. A scrambled visitor token. Whether it looks like a robot. The browser's full identification text (its "user agent", which can include the phone model and software versions). Only while the code's tracking window is active.
Not recorded	Their internet (IP) address is not stored: it is used only to work out the approximate place and the scrambled token, then discarded. Also not recorded: names, email addresses, tracking cookies (none are used), the full address of the page they came from (only its website name), or anything they type.
Who can see it	Every signed-in user, admins and members. Never visitors.
Kept for	365 days, then deleted automatically.

Someone scans a static QR code

Recorded	Nothing. A static code holds its content itself, so scanning it never contacts this system. (What you typed to make the code, such as a Wi-Fi password, is stored here so you can rename and re-download it.)
Not recorded	Everything about the person scanning.
Who can see it	Not applicable.
Kept for	The code's details are kept until you delete the code.

Someone opens a password-protected code

Recorded	A scan is recorded only after the right password is entered, and then like any other scan. The password itself is stored only in scrambled (hashed) form.
Not recorded	Opening the password page and wrong guesses are not recorded as scans. Wrong guesses are only slowed down (six a minute), using a short-lived count held in memory. The one cookie a visitor can ever receive is a security token on this password page: it lasts 30 minutes, makes the form safe to submit, and holds nothing about the visitor.
Who can see it	Every signed-in user.
Kept for	365 days, then deleted automatically.

Someone opens a link page

Recorded	The time. Which page. Whether they arrived from one of its QR codes or another way. An approximate country. Device type, operating system and browser name. Their language setting. The name of the website or app they came from. A scrambled visitor token. Whether it looks like a robot. Whether it is their first visit that day.
Not recorded	Their internet address, region or town, the browser's full identification text, names, email addresses, cookies of any kind, or the full address of the page they came from.
Who can see it	Every signed-in user.
Kept for	365 days, then deleted automatically.

Someone presses a web button on a link page

Recorded	The same details as opening the page, plus which button was pressed.
Not recorded	Where they go next, once they have left this system.
Who can see it	Every signed-in user.
Kept for	365 days, then deleted automatically.

Someone presses an email or phone button on a link page

Recorded	Nothing. These open the visitor's own email or phone app directly.
Not recorded	Everything. They cannot be counted.
Who can see it	Not applicable.
Kept for	Not applicable.

You use the live preview, or the page and QR design previews

Recorded	Nothing. Nothing is saved or counted, and buttons in a preview open in a new tab.
Not recorded	Everything.
Who can see it	Not applicable.
Kept for	Not applicable.

Someone signs in to this admin

Recorded	For each attempt: the time, whether it worked, and a scrambled, keyed form of the address it came from, used only to stop password guessing. For each sign-in: a scrambled session token, which user, and when it started, was last used and expires.
Not recorded	The user name typed in a failed attempt, the password (only a scrambled hash of each user's own password exists), and the visitor's real address.
Who can see it	Nobody sees these in the admin. They work in the background.
Kept for	Attempts: 24 hours. Sessions: until they expire (12 hours without use, 7 days at most) or you sign out.

You or a colleague do something in the admin

Recorded	The activity log: who (user name), what (for example created a QR code, saved a design, reset a password, created a page), which item, and when.
Not recorded	Passwords, and anything typed into a form beyond the name of the item.
Who can see it	Admins, on the Users page.
Kept for	365 days, then deleted automatically.

Someone downloads an export (CSV)

Recorded	The download itself is not logged. The file contains every field recorded for each scan, including the scrambled visitor token and the browser's full identification text. The address column is empty unless full-address storage is on.
Not recorded	Not applicable.
Who can see it	Every signed-in user can download exports, so treat the files as personal data.

Kept for The file is yours once downloaded: store and delete it as you would any personal data.

Any request to the website, in the web server's own log

Recorded	The time, the address requested (including anything after a question mark), the response code and size, the browser's identification text and the language setting.
Not recorded	Visitor internet addresses, cookies, passwords and the address of the page the visitor came from are removed before anything is written.
Who can see it	Only people with access to the server.
Kept for	By the server's own system log, under the server's settings. This application's retention period does not control it.

Every stored field

These are all the tables that hold information about activity, with every field they contain. If a field is not listed here, it is not stored.

Each scan of a dynamic QR code

One row per scan. Shown in a code's statistics, and in its CSV export.

Field	What it holds
id	An internal row number.
link_id	Which QR code was scanned.
scanned_at	The exact time, in UTC.
ip_hash	A scrambled visitor token: a one-way scramble of the internet address and a secret that changes every day. It cannot be turned back into an address, and cannot be matched from one day to the next.
ip	The visitor's actual internet address. Empty unless full-address storage has been switched on by the system administrator.
country	Two-letter country code, estimated from the internet address.
country_name	Country name, estimated.
region	Region or county, estimated. Often wrong on mobile networks.
city	Town or city, estimated. Treat as a guide only.
language	The language setting of the visitor's phone or browser, such as en-GB.
destination_url	Where this visitor was actually sent (smart routing can differ per visitor).
device_class	mobile, tablet, desktop, or bot.
os	Operating system name, such as iOS or Android.
browser	Browser name, such as Safari or Chrome.
referrer_host	The name of the website or app they came from (never the full address).
user_agent	The browser's full identification text, up to 512 characters. It can include the phone model and software versions.
is_bot	Whether it looks like a robot or link-preview fetcher. Robots are left out of the headline numbers.
is_unique	Whether this is the first time that scrambled token was seen on this code in 24 hours.

Each view of a link page and each button press

One row per view or click. Shown in a link page's statistics. Link pages record less than QR scans: no region, town or browser identification text.

Field	What it holds
id	An internal row number.
page_id	Which link page.
item_id	Which button was pressed (0 for a page view).
at	The exact time, in UTC.
kind	view or click.
source	qr if they arrived through one of the page's QR codes, otherwise direct.
ip_hash	A scrambled visitor token, as for scans.
country	Two-letter country code, estimated.
country_name	Country name, estimated.
device_class	mobile, tablet, desktop, or bot.
os	Operating system name.
browser	Browser name.
language	The language setting of the visitor's phone or browser.
referrer_host	The name of the website or app they came from.
is_bot	Whether it looks like a robot.
is_unique	For a view: first time that scrambled token was seen on this page in 24 hours.

Sign-in attempts

Kept for 24 hours. Used only to lock out repeated wrong guesses.

Field	What it holds
ip	A scrambled, keyed form of the address the attempt came from (never the address itself).
attempted_at	The time of the attempt.
success	Whether the attempt worked.

Signed-in sessions

One row per browser that is signed in.

Field	What it holds
id	An internal row number.
user_id	Which user.
token_hash	A scrambled form of the secret held by the browser. The secret itself is not stored.
csrf_token	A random value that protects forms from being submitted by other websites.
created_at	When the session started.
last_seen_at	When it was last used (a session ends after 12 hours without use).
expires_at	The latest time it can last (7 days after it started).

The activity log

Shown to admins on the Users page.

Field	What it holds
id	An internal row number.
at	When it happened.
actor	Who did it: a user name (or "server" for a recovery done on the server).
action	What they did, such as qr.create or user.reset_password.
target	What it was done to: a code, a page, a design or a user name.
detail	A short note. Never a password.

Daily secrets

Used to make the scrambled visitor tokens. Deleted after 3 days, which is why tokens cannot be matched across days.

Field	What it holds
day	Which day the secret is for.
salt	The random secret.

User accounts

The people who can sign in.

Field	What it holds
id	An internal row number.
username	The sign-in name.
password_hash	A scrambled (bcrypt) form of the password. The password itself cannot be recovered, by anyone.
must_change_password	Whether they must choose a new password at next sign-in.
role	admin or member.
created_at	When the account was made.
updated_at	When it was last changed.

The scrambled visitor token

To count "unique" visitors without keeping anyone's address, each visit is given a token: a one-way scramble of the visitor's internet address mixed with a secret that is made fresh every day. The same person gets the same token all day, so they are counted once. The token cannot be turned back into an address, and tomorrow's token for the same person is different, so people cannot be followed from day to day. The daily secrets are deleted after three days.

Places are estimates worked out from the internet address using a free location database. Country is usually right; town and region are guesses.

Your responsibilities

- Your privacy notice should say that scans of QR codes and visits to link pages are counted, with approximate location, device details and language, and how long they are kept. If full-address storage is on, it must say that too.
- **Exports are personal data.** A CSV includes the scrambled token and the browser's identification text for every scan. Store and delete exports as you would any personal data.
- Because no name or address is kept, an individual scan cannot be linked to a person afterwards. There is also no way to delete a single scan; deleting a QR code or a link page deletes all of its records, and everything else is deleted automatically when it reaches 365 days.
- The web server keeps its own system log. Visitor addresses, cookies and the referring page's address are removed from it, but it does keep the address requested, the browser's identification text and the language setting, under the server's own retention settings.

5. Making a QR code, step by step

What it is. The form where you say what the code does and how it looks. Press **New QR code**, then choose a type.

1. **Details.** The *Name* is only for you. The *Campaign* groups codes by where they are used (see [Campaigns](#)). Typing in the campaign box suggests existing ones, and "Leaflet" and "leaflet" are treated as the same

campaign.

2. **The type's own boxes.** What you enter depends on the type; the grey text under the heading tells you. See [Every type of QR code](#).
3. **Tracking window and Limits and protection** (dynamic codes only). See [Tracking window](#) and [Scan limits and passwords](#).
4. **Design.** Colours, shapes, frame, text and logo, with a live preview. See [Designing the look](#). You can also save the design for next time: [How to save and reuse designs](#).
5. Press **Create QR code**. If something is wrong, the page stays open and tells you what to fix, next to the box concerned.

Boxes marked with an asterisk (*) are required. The form refuses anything that would make a broken code: a web address that is not `http` or `https`, a design too pale to scan, content too long to fit in a QR code, and so on.

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New Website link QR code Dynamic

▼ **What is this? How do I use it?**

What it is. Where you say what the code does and how it looks. The picture on the right is a live preview.

How to use it. Work down the page: name it, enter what it should do, choose the look, then press Create. Always scan a printed test before you use a code for real. [Read more in Help](#)

What is tracked. A dynamic code records every scan while its tracking window is active (the full list is in Help). A static code records nothing. Saving is written to the activity log with your user name. [Full list](#)

Details

What it is. Labels that keep your codes organised. **How to use it.** Give each code a clear name such as "Autumn leaflet, front page", and choose or type a campaign for where it will be used. [Help](#)

Name (only you see this)

Campaign (where it is used: leaflet, exhibition stand, product box ...)

Website link

What it is. Open any web page. **How to use it.** Type or paste the full web address, starting with `https://`. Open it in your browser first to make sure it works. As a dynamic code you can change the address later without reprinting; as a static code it is

Design

What it is. The look of the code: colours, dot and corner shapes, a frame with a few words, and a logo in the middle. **How to use it.** Change anything and the preview updates. Keep the code dark on a light background so it scans reliably; the form will warn you if you go too far. [Help](#)

The preview is a sample. Always scan a printed test code before you use it.

Figure 4. The QR code form: details, what the code does, and a live preview of its design.

6. Every type of QR code, and what to enter

What it is. The kinds of thing a code can do. Each shows whether it can be static, dynamic or both, then what it does and how to fill it in. This list is generated from the same catalogue the forms use, so it always matches.

Website link dynamic static

Open any web page.

How to use it. Type or paste the full web address, starting with https://. Open it in your browser first to make sure it works. As a dynamic code you can change the address later without reprinting; as a static code it is built into the picture for good.

Boxes: Web address (required).

Google Form dynamic static

Open a survey or form.

How to use it. In Google Forms click Send, choose the link tab and copy the link (it starts docs.google.com or forms.gle). Paste it here. Scanning opens the form on the phone.

Boxes: Form link (required).

Google review dynamic static

Ask for a review on Google.

How to use it. In your Google Business Profile choose Ask for reviews and copy your short review link (it starts g.page). Paste it here. Scanning opens your Google review box.

Boxes: Review link (required).

App stores dynamic

One code, the right store: iPhones go to the App Store, Android to Google Play.

How to use it. Paste your App Store link, your Google Play link and a web page for everyone else. iPhones and iPads go to the App Store, Android phones to Google Play, and computers to the web page. Use one printed code for all of them.

Boxes: App Store link (required), Google Play link (required), Everyone else (required).

Smart URL dynamic

Send people to different pages by device, system, language or country.

How to use it. Set a default address, then add up to five rules. Each rule says: if the visitor's device, system, language or country is this, send them to that address. Rules are checked top to bottom and the first match wins; anyone who matches none goes to the default. Country rules need two-letter codes such as GB or FR.

Boxes: Default address (required), Rule 1: if the visitor's, Rule 1: is, Rule 1: send them to, Rule 2: if the visitor's, Rule 2: is, Rule 2: send them to, Rule 3: if the visitor's, Rule 3: is, Rule 3: send them to, Rule 4: if the visitor's, Rule 4: is, Rule 4: send them to, Rule 5: if the visitor's, Rule 5: is, Rule 5: send them to.

Contact card (vCard) dynamic static

Save a contact to the phone's address book.

How to use it. Fill in the details you want people to save. Only a name or a company is required. Scanning offers to add the contact to the phone. As a dynamic code you can correct the details later without reprinting; as a static code the details are printed in the picture, which makes the code denser, so keep it short.

Boxes: First name, Last name, Company, Job title, Phone, Mobile, Email, Website, Street, Town / city, Postcode, Country, Note.

Email static

Start an email to an address.

How to use it. Enter the address to write to, and optionally a subject and a message. Scanning opens the phone's email app with these already filled in.

Boxes: Send to (required), Subject, Message.

SMS text message static

Start a text message.

How to use it. Enter the phone number with its country code (for example +44) and an optional message. Scanning opens the messages app ready to send.

Boxes: Phone number (required), Message.

Phone call static

Dial a number.

How to use it. Enter the phone number with its country code. Scanning offers to call it.

Boxes: Phone number (required).

WhatsApp dynamic static

Open a WhatsApp chat, optionally with a message ready to send.

How to use it. Enter the WhatsApp number with its country code, digits only (for example 447700900123), and an optional first message. Scanning opens a WhatsApp chat with that number.

Boxes: WhatsApp number (required), Message.

Facebook dynamic static

Send people to your Facebook page, profile or post.

How to use it. Open the page, profile or post in your browser (or the app's Share button) and copy its link, then paste it here. The address is checked, so a link to the wrong site is caught.

Boxes: Facebook link (required).

Instagram dynamic static

Send people to your Instagram page, profile or post.

How to use it. Open the page, profile or post in your browser (or the app's Share button) and copy its link, then paste it here. The address is checked, so a link to the wrong site is caught.

Boxes: Instagram link (required).

YouTube dynamic static

Send people to your YouTube page, profile or post.

How to use it. Open the page, profile or post in your browser (or the app's Share button) and copy its link, then paste it here. The address is checked, so a link to the wrong site is caught.

Boxes: YouTube link (required).

TikTok dynamic static

Send people to your TikTok page, profile or post.

How to use it. Open the page, profile or post in your browser (or the app's Share button) and copy its link, then paste it here. The address is checked, so a link to the wrong site is caught.

Boxes: TikTok link (required).

X (Twitter) dynamic static

Send people to your X (Twitter) page, profile or post.

How to use it. Open the page, profile or post in your browser (or the app's Share button) and copy its link, then paste it here. The address is checked, so a link to the wrong site is caught.

Boxes: X (Twitter) link (required).

Pinterest dynamic static

Send people to your Pinterest page, profile or post.

How to use it. Open the page, profile or post in your browser (or the app's Share button) and copy its link, then paste it here. The address is checked, so a link to the wrong site is caught.

Boxes: Pinterest link (required).

LinkedIn dynamic static

Send people to your LinkedIn page, profile or post.

How to use it. Open the page, profile or post in your browser (or the app's Share button) and copy its link, then paste it here. The address is checked, so a link to the wrong site is caught.

Boxes: LinkedIn link (required).

Location dynamic static

Show a place on the map.

How to use it. Enter the latitude and longitude of the place. In Google Maps, right-click the spot and click the two numbers at the top of the menu to copy them. Scanning opens the map at that point.

Boxes: Latitude (required), Longitude (required), Place name.

Calendar event dynamic static

Add an event to the phone's calendar.

How to use it. Give the event a title, a start and an end (UK time), and optionally where and some details. Scanning offers to add the event to the phone's calendar.

Boxes: Event title (required), Starts (UK time) (required), Ends (UK time) (required), Where, Details.

Wi-Fi network static

Let guests join Wi-Fi by scanning. Static only: it has to work before they are online.

How to use it. Enter the network name exactly as it appears (capital letters matter), the password, and the security type (most business and home Wi-Fi is WPA). Scanning offers to join the network without anyone typing the password. Wi-Fi codes are always static, because the phone is not online yet when it scans.

Boxes: Network name (SSID) (required), Password, Security, Hidden network.

Plain text static

Show a short piece of text.

How to use it. Type the message. Scanning simply shows the text. It needs no internet connection.

Boxes: Text (required).

7. Designing the look of a code

What it is. The *Design* panel changes how the code looks without changing what it does. The picture on top is a live preview of a sample code. **How to use each control:**

Code colour and Background

The colour of the dots and of the paper behind them. The code must be **darker than its background** and the contrast must be at least 4 to 1. If you choose pale yellow dots, or a light code on a dark background, the preview shows a message and the form will not save it: many phone cameras cannot read those.

Dot style

square (classic), *rounded* (softened squares) or *dots* (circles).

Corner style and Corner colour

The three large squares in the corners. *square*, *rounded* or *circle*. Tick *Corners match the dots* to use one colour, or untick it to colour the corners differently (they must also be dark enough).

Frame and Text under the code

none, *box* (a coloured border with a label underneath) or *banner* (just a label strip). The text is up to 24 characters, for example "SCAN ME" or "SCAN FOR THE MANUAL". If you choose a frame and leave the text empty it says "SCAN ME".

Error correction

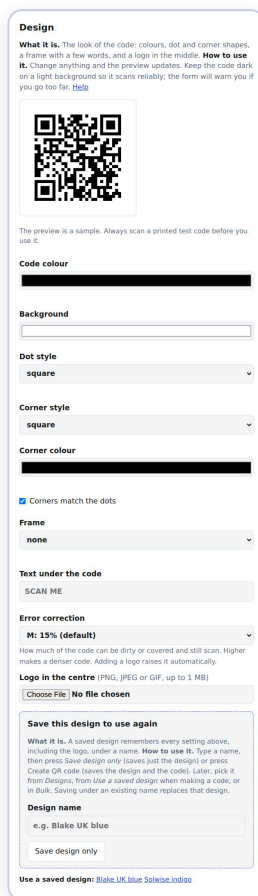
How much of the picture can be dirty, scratched or covered and still scan. *L* 7%, *M* 15% (the default), *Q* 25%, *H* 30%. Higher is more forgiving but makes the code denser. Use *H* on rough surfaces such as packaging.

Logo in the centre

Upload a PNG, JPEG or GIF up to 1 MB. It is resized to fit in the middle, covering about 5% of the code. A logo hides part of the code, so the error correction is raised to at least *Q* automatically. The upload is re-saved as a clean image; other kinds of file are refused.

The preview and the real thing. The preview is a sample of how the style looks; the real code holds your real address. Always scan a real printed code with a phone before you use it.

Safe combinations. Every colour, shape, frame and logo combination offered here has been tested by decoding the result with real QR-reading software. If something is risky, the form refuses it rather than letting you print a code that does not work.



Design

What it is. The look of the code: colours, dot and corner shapes, a frame with a few words, and a logo in the middle. **How to use it.** Change anything and the preview updates. Keep the code dark on a light background so it scans reliably; the form will warn you if you go too far. [Help](#)

The preview is a sample. Always scan a printed test code before you use it.

Code colour
[Black color swatch]

Background
[White color swatch]

Dot style
square

Corner style
square

Corner colour
[Black color swatch]

☒ Corners match the dots

Frame
none

Text under the code
SCAN ME

Error correction
M: 15% (default)

How much of the code can be dirty or covered and still scan. Higher makes a denser code. Adding a logo raises it automatically.

Logo in the centre (PNG, JPEG or GIF, up to 1 MB)
Choose File No file chosen

Save this design to use again

What it is. A saved design remembers every setting above, including the logo, under a name. **How to use it.** Type a name, then press Save design only (saves just the design) or press Create QR code (saves the design and the code). Later, pick it from Designs, from Use a saved design when making a code, or in Bulk. Saving under an existing name replaces that design.

Design name
e.g. Blake UK blue

Save design only

Use a saved design: [Blake UK blue](#) [Solawise indigo](#)

Figure 5. The Design panel: colours, dot and corner styles, frame and text, logo, error correction and saved designs.

8. How to save and reuse designs

What it is. A *saved design* remembers the whole look under a name: colours, dot and corner styles, frame, text, error correction and logo. Use it to keep every code on-brand without setting everything up again.

Saving a design: two ways

Way 1: on its own (easiest).

1. Press **Designs** in the menu, then **New design**.
2. Choose the colours, shapes, frame, text and logo. Watch the preview.
3. Type a name under **Save this design to use again**, for example "Blake UK blue".
4. Press **Save design**. You land on the Designs page and see it there with a thumbnail.

Way 2: while making or editing a code.

1. Set the design as you like in the *Design* panel.
2. Type a name in the *Design name* box under *Save this design to use again*.

3. Either press **Save design only** (saves just the design; your code is not created yet), or press **Create QR code / Save changes** (saves the design *and* the code).

If you press *Save design only* without typing a name, the page asks you for one.

Using a saved design

- **When making a code:** choose a type, and under *Design* click the design's name next to *Use a saved design*. The panel fills in with it (including the logo). You can still adjust it for this code.
- **From the Designs page:** press *Use for a new code* under a design. That opens the form for a website link with the design applied; change the type from the New QR code chooser if you need a different one.
- **In bulk:** pick it from the *Design* list on the [Bulk](#) page so that every code in the batch uses it.

Changing, replacing and deleting

- **Change a design:** Designs, then *Edit* under it, make your changes and press *Save design*. Because the name is the same, it **replaces** the old version.
- **Save a variation:** open a design with *Edit*, change the name, and save. You now have both.
- **Delete a design:** press *Delete* under it and confirm. Codes already made with it are not affected.

Good to know

- Designs are **shared by everyone** who signs in, so a colleague can use the brand design you saved.
- A design only stores the *look*. It never contains a web address or any content.
- Applying a design **copies** it to the code. Editing the saved design later does not change codes already made; to restyle an existing code, open it and use *Edit*.
- Design names are not case sensitive ("Blake blue" and "blake BLUE" are the same name) and can be up to 60 characters.

QR Codes [Codes](#) [New QR code](#) [Campaigns](#) [Link pages](#) [Bulk](#) [Designs](#) [Export scans](#) [Users](#) [Help](#) [Sign out \(admin\)](#) 

Saved designs New design

▼ **What is this? How do I use it?**

What it is. Saved designs: reusable looks (colours, dot and corner styles, frame, text and logo) so that every code you make can match your brand.

How to use it. Press New design to make one, or Edit to change one. To use one, choose Use for a new code, or pick it in the Design box when making codes in bulk. [Read more in Help](#)

What is tracked. Saving, editing or deleting a design is written to the activity log. A design holds only the look, never visitor information. [Full list](#)



Blake UK blue

No logo

Use for a new code

Edit

Delete



Solwise indigo

No logo

Use for a new code

Edit

Delete

Approximate locations: [IP Geolocation by DB-IP](#). Town and region are estimates and can be wrong, especially on mobile networks.

Figure 6. Saved designs: reuse a look on any code, edit it, or delete it.

9. Tracking window and what happens at the end

What it is. For a dynamic code, the dates during which scans are counted. **How to use it.**

- **Preset:** 24 hours, 7, 30 or 90 days, counted from the moment you press Create.
- **Custom:** choose *Custom* and type the start and end, in UK time. Daylight saving is handled for you.
- **Before the start** the code already works and sends people on, but the scans are not counted.
- **When the window ends** (or the scan limit is reached) the code does one of three things, your choice: *keep redirecting and stop counting* (the default, so printed codes never break), *show an "expired" page*, or *send people to a fallback address* such as your home page.
- You can edit the window at any time, for example to extend a campaign. Scans already recorded stay.

The code status on the Codes page is *scheduled*, *active* or *ended*. A code you have switched off shows a *disabled* badge.

Tracking window

What it is. The dates during which scans are counted. **How to use it.** Pick a preset (it counts from now) or Custom to type exact UK start and end times. Choose what should happen when the window ends or the scan limit is reached. [Help](#)

Preset

7 days from now

Start (UK time)

10/09/2026, 12:30 PM

End (UK time)

10/16/2026, 12:30 PM

Scans are only counted inside the window. The code keeps working outside it.

When the window ends, or the scan limit is reached

Keep redirecting, stop counting (default)

Fallback address (only for "Redirect to a fallback address")

<https://www.blake-uk.com/>

Figure 7. Tracking window and what happens when it ends.

10. Scan limits and passwords

What they are. Two optional controls on a dynamic code.

Scan limit. Stops the code after that many *people* have scanned it. Bots and link-preview robots do not use up the limit. When it is reached the code behaves as if its window had ended (see above). Leave the box empty for no limit. The code's page shows how many have been used, for example "37 of 500 used". Raising the limit by editing brings the code back to life.

Password. Visitors see a page asking for the password and are only sent on when they type it correctly. Good for trade-only pages. Notes:

- The password is 4 to 72 characters. It is stored scrambled, never readable.
- A visit is only counted as a scan once the right password is entered.
- Wrong guesses are slowed down: after six in a minute a visitor has to wait.
- Editing a code with the password box empty **keeps** the current password. Tick *Remove the password* to take it off, or type a new one to change it.
- The password protects the destination, but the printed code itself is not secret: anyone can scan it and see the password page.

Limits and protection

What it is. Optional controls over who gets through. **How to use it.** A scan limit stops the code after that many people (for a limited offer). A password makes visitors type it before they are sent on (for trade-only pages). Leave both empty for an open code. [Help](#)

Scan limit (people, not bots; empty = unlimited)

e.g. 500

Password (visitors must enter it before they are sent on)

no password

Figure 8. Limits and protection: a scan limit and a password.

11. Sending people to different places (smart routing)

What it is. One printed code that sends different people to different addresses, for a dynamic code of type *App stores* or *Smart URL*.

How to use it.

- **App stores:** enter your App Store link, Google Play link and a web page for everyone else. iPhones and iPads go to the first, Android to the second, all others to the third.
- **Smart URL:** set a default address, then up to five rules. Each rule has three parts: what to look at (operating system, device type, language or country), the value, and where to send people who match. Rules are checked from top to bottom and **the first match wins**. Anyone matching none goes to the default.
- **Values:** operating system is iOS, Android, Windows, macOS, Linux or ChromeOS. Device is mobile, tablet or desktop. Language is a code such as `en` or `fr-FR` (`cy` matches Welsh in any region). Country is a two-letter code such as GB or FR.
- Each scan records where *that* visitor was actually sent, so the statistics show how your rules are used.
- Country rules rely on the approximate location database; if a visitor's country cannot be worked out, a country rule will not match them.

Tracking URL

What it is. The short address hidden inside the QR picture. Every scan passes through it, which is how scans are counted and why the destination can be changed later. **How to use it.** You rarely need to copy it, but you can paste it into a message to test the code without a printer.

<https://qr.blakegroup.uk/r/A0ELZW52>
Copy

Destination: **Blake UK website**
<https://www.blake-uk.com/>

Smart routing (first match wins):

1. if country is **FR** go to <https://www.blake-uk.com/fr>
2. if os is **iOS** go to <https://www.blake-uk.com/ios>
3. otherwise the destination above

Window: 09 Oct 2026 12:30 to 07 Jan 2027 11:30 (UK time)
89d 23h left in the tracking window

After the window or limit: keeps redirecting, no longer counted

Campaign: [Exhibition stand](#)

Figure 9. A smart-routing code lists its rules; the first match wins.

12. What your visitors see

What it is. The experience of the people who scan your codes or open your link pages, so you know what to expect and what to tell them.

An ordinary dynamic code

The visitor is sent straight on to the destination. Nothing is shown from this system, and it takes a fraction of a second.

A code that has not started, or has ended

While the tracking window has not started, the code works but is not counted. When it has ended (or the scan limit is reached) it does what you chose: keeps redirecting without counting, shows an *This link has expired* page, or sends the visitor to your fallback address.

A password-protected code

A page titled *This code is protected* asks for the password. The right password sends the visitor on. A wrong one shows *That password is not right*. After six wrong guesses in a minute they must wait.

A code you have switched off

Link disabled: this link has been switched off.

A code that was deleted, mistyped or never existed

Link not found.

Too many visits from one visitor

Too many requests: please wait a minute. This only affects someone making more than 30 requests a minute.

A contact card (vCard) or calendar event code

The phone offers to save the contact or add the event.

A smart-routing or app-stores code

The visitor is sent to whichever address matches their phone, language or country, with no page in between.

A static code

The phone acts on the content directly (opens the web address, joins the Wi-Fi, shows the text). This system is not involved.

A link page

A page with the company logo, the heading and a row of buttons. Pressing a web button goes through this system for a moment, to be counted, and on to the destination. Email and phone buttons open the visitor's own app directly. A page that is switched off, deleted or mistyped shows *Page not found*.

Visitors never see a sign-in page or any of the admin. None of these pages asks them for any personal details.

13. Downloading, printing and testing

What it is. Getting the picture out of the system and onto paper or a screen. Open a code and use the *QR code* panel.

- **SVG** is a vector picture that stays sharp at any size. Use it for anything professionally printed, and give it to your printer.
- **PNG 256, 512, 1024** are ordinary pictures that many pixels wide. Use them in documents, emails, slides and websites. 1024 is best for anything that will be enlarged. A code with a frame is taller than it is wide.
- The download always uses the code's current design. If you change the design, download it again.
- The picture of a *dynamic* code does not change when you edit where it goes, so printed copies stay valid.

Printing checklist.

1. Make it big enough: at least about 2 cm (0.8 in) across for scanning from close up, and bigger for posters or anything scanned from further away (as a rough guide, one tenth of the scanning distance).
2. Keep the blank border around the code. Do not crop it, and do not print over it.
3. Keep strong contrast: dark code on a light background. Never print it inverted (light on dark).
4. Avoid shiny, curved or heavily textured surfaces that reflect light. On rough or curved surfaces use error correction H.
5. **Scan a printed test with two different phones** (one iPhone and one Android if you can) before printing the full run.

The screenshot shows the Blake UK QR code management interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with links: QR Codes, Codes, New QR code, Campaigns, Link pages, Bulk, Designs, Export scans, Users, Help. On the right, there's a 'Sign out (admin)' button and the Blake UK logo. Below the navigation bar, the main header shows the code name 'Autumn leaflet, front page' with a status 'Active' and a 'Website Link' tab. There are three buttons: 'Edit', 'Disable', and 'Delete'. A dropdown menu is open showing 'What is this? How do I use it?'. The dropdown contains three sections: 'What it is.' (One QR code: its picture, where it goes and, for a dynamic code, every scan and what the statistics say.), 'How to use it.' (Download the picture from the QR code panel. Use Edit to change anything, Disable to switch a code off without deleting it, and read the numbers below to see how it is doing. [Read more in Help](#)), and 'What is tracked.' (This page only shows what was recorded when people scanned: time, approximate place, device, system, browser, language, where they were sent, referring site name and a scrambled visitor token. Never a name, an email address or an exact internet address. [Full list](#)). Below the dropdown, there are two main panels. The left panel is titled 'Tracking URL' and contains the following text: 'What it is.' (The short address hidden inside the QR picture. Every scan passes through it, which is how scans are counted and why the destination can be changed later. **How to use it.** You rarely need to copy it, but you can paste it into a message to test the code without a printer.) Below this is the URL 'https://qr.blakegroup.uk/r/neNaVga5' with a 'Copy' button. Further down, it says 'Destination: **Blake UK website**' followed by the URL 'https://www.blake-uk.com/category/aerials.html'. Then, 'Window: 09 Oct 2026 12:30 to 07 Jan 2027 11:30 (UK time)' and '89d 23h left in the tracking window'. Below that, 'After the window or limit: keeps redirecting, no longer counted'. Finally, 'Campaign: [Leaflet](#)'. The right panel is titled 'QR code' and contains the following text: 'What it is.' (The picture to print or share. **How to use it.** Download SVG for printing at any size (best for leaflets, packaging and signs) or PNG for documents and screens (the number is the width in pixels). Scan it with a phone before you print. To change the look, use Edit.) Below this is a QR code image. At the bottom of the right panel, it says 'Error correction M. Change the look, logo or text with Edit. Always scan a printed code to test it.'

Figure 10. A code's page: tracking address, the QR picture and its PNG and SVG downloads.

14. Reading the statistics

What it is. Open any dynamic code to see how it is performing. Static codes have no statistics, because their scans never reach this system.

All scans

Every visit by a person while the code was being tracked.

Unique

Different visitors. A visitor counts once in any 24 hours, so someone who scans three times in a morning is one unique visitor. The figure uses a scrambled form of their internet address, not the address itself.

Bots

Robots, not people: search engines, and the "link preview" fetchers that chat apps like WhatsApp and Slack use when a link is pasted. They are recorded but kept out of the headline numbers. Press *Include bots* to see them, or *Hide bots* to hide them again.

Scans over time

A bar chart in UK time: by the hour when the tracking window is under three days, otherwise by the day. Hover over a bar for its number.

Breakdown boxes

The ten most common values for device (mobile, tablet, desktop), operating system, browser, language, country, region, town and referring site, each with a percentage.

Referrer

The website or app the visitor came from, when their phone tells us (for example `l.facebook.com`). Only the site name is kept, never the full address.

Individual scans

Every scan, newest first, 50 to a page: exact UK date and time, campaign, approximate place, device, system, browser, language and where they were sent. *New visitor* marks someone not seen on this code in the previous 24 hours.

Place

Worked out from the visitor's internet address using a free location database, so it is an **estimate**. Country is usually right; the town is often just the nearest big town; mobile networks and VPNs can show the wrong region.

Export CSV

Downloads the scans as a spreadsheet file. *Export CSV* on a code gives that code; *Export scans* in the menu gives every code, with the campaign on each row. Times appear in both UTC and UK time.



Figure 11. Scans: totals and a chart by the day (UK time).

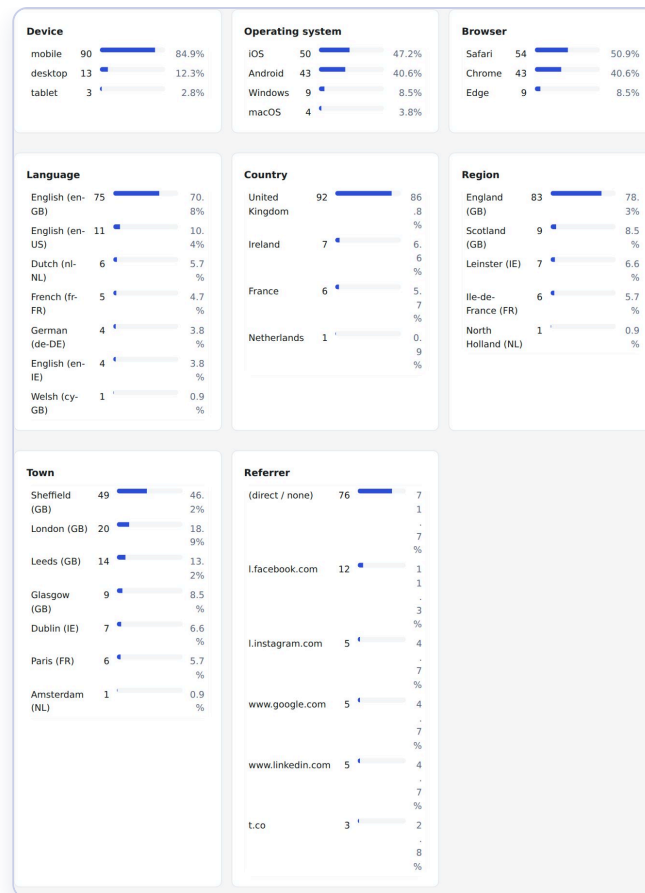


Figure 12. Breakdowns by device, system, browser, language, country, region, town and referrer.

15. Exporting your data (CSV)

What it is. A spreadsheet file of scan records, to open in Excel or Google Sheets. **How to use it.** On a QR code's page press *Export CSV* for that code, or press *Export scans* in the menu for every code. Link pages have no export yet.

What is in it. One row per scan, oldest first, **including robots**, which are marked `is_bot = 1` so you can filter them out. Columns:

<code>scanned_at_utc</code> , <code>scanned_at_local</code>	The time, in UTC and in UK time.
<code>campaign</code> , <code>link_label</code> , <code>link_code</code>	Which campaign, which code (its name) and its short code.
<code>destination</code> , <code>destination_site</code>	Where that visitor was sent, and a friendly name for the site.
<code>country</code> , <code>region</code> , <code>town</code>	Estimated place.
<code>language</code> , <code>device</code> , <code>os</code> , <code>browser</code>	The visitor's language setting and device details.
<code>referrer_host</code>	The name of the site or app they came from.
<code>is_bot</code> , <code>is_unique</code>	1 or 0.

ip	Empty, unless full-address storage is on.
ip_hash	The scrambled visitor token (changes daily).
user_agent	The browser's full identification text.

Text that a spreadsheet could mistake for a formula is prefixed with an apostrophe, so opening an export cannot run anything. Anyone who is signed in can export, so handle the files as personal data (see [What is tracked](#)).

16. Campaigns

What it is. A short label saying *where* a code is used: Leaflet, Exhibition stand, Product box, Van, Trade counter and so on. It is how you compare placements.

How to use it.

- Set it when you create or edit a code. Type your own or pick a suggestion.
- The **Campaigns** page adds up the scans, unique visitors and bots for every campaign, with the last scan time. Codes with no campaign are listed last.
- Click a campaign name, on that page or on the Codes page, to list just its codes.
- Capital letters do not matter: "Leaflet" and "leaflet" are one campaign. Names can be up to 60 characters.
- It is one flat list (no folders inside folders).

QR Codes
[Codes](#)
[New QR code](#)
[Campaigns](#)
[Link pages](#)
[Bulk](#)
[Designs](#)
[Export scans](#)
[Users](#)
[Help](#)

Sign out (admin)


Campaigns

Export all scans (CSV)

▼ What is this? How do I use it?

What it is. A campaign is a label for where a code is used, such as Leaflet, Exhibition stand or Product box. This page adds up the scans of every code in each campaign.

How to use it. Give a code a campaign when you create or edit it. Click a campaign name to list just its codes, and use Export to take every scan into a spreadsheet. [Read more in Help](#)

What is tracked. Nothing extra. These are totals of the same scan records. [Full list](#)

Where your QR codes are used, and how each placement performs. Give a link a campaign with Edit (leaflet, exhibition stand, product box ...). Counts exclude bots and link-preview fetchers.

CAMPAIGN	QR CODES	SCANS	UNIQUE VISITORS	BOTS EXCLUDED	LAST SCAN
Exhibition stand	2	373	267	9	09 Oct 2026 20:09
Product box	2	272	205	11	09 Oct 2026 20:38
Trade counter	2	226	161	13	09 Oct 2026 19:06
Link pages	1	192	126	6	09 Oct 2026 18:11
Leaflet	1	106	82	3	09 Oct 2026 20:16
Reception	2	0	0	0	never
TOTAL	10	1169	841	42	

Approximate locations: [IP Geolocation by DB-IP](#). Town and region are estimates and can be wrong, especially on mobile networks.

Figure 13. Campaigns add up the scans of every code in each campaign.

17. Editing, disabling and deleting a code

What it is. The buttons at the top of a code's page.

- **Edit.** A *dynamic* code: change the name, campaign, destination or contents, window, limits, password and look. The tracking address and the type never change, so printed codes keep working. A *static* code: only the name, campaign and look can change, because its content is printed in the picture.
- **Disable / Enable** (dynamic only). Switches the code off without deleting it: visitors see a "Link disabled" page. Enable turns it back on. Use it to pause a campaign.
- **Delete.** Removes the code *and all its scans*, and cannot be undone. A deleted dynamic code stops working wherever it is printed (scans show "Link not found"). Deleting a static code does not affect printed copies, which keep working.

18. Making many codes at once (bulk)

What it is. One tracked code per row of a spreadsheet, returned as a ZIP file. Good for a catalogue of products. Open **Bulk** in the menu.

1. In your spreadsheet put the headings `label` and `url` in the first row (and optionally `campaign`), then one code per row. Save as **CSV**. Example:

```
label,url,campaign
Aerial A1 box,https://www.blake-uk.com/aerials/a1.html,Product box
```
2. On the Bulk page choose the file.
3. Set a default *campaign* for rows without one, the *tracking window*, and the *images* you want (SVG only, PNG only, or both).
4. Optionally pick a saved *Design* (so all the codes match your brand) and the error correction.
5. Press **Create codes and download ZIP**.

The ZIP holds a picture of each code (named by its code) and `codes.csv` , which lists each row's label, campaign, destination, tracking address and code so you can match them to your products.

- **All or nothing:** if any row is wrong (for example an address that does not start with `https://`), nothing is created and the page lists the rows to fix, by spreadsheet row number.
- **Limits:** up to 1,000 rows when you ask for SVG only, and up to 250 rows when PNG is included (PNG takes longer to draw). Split larger files.
- Bulk makes dynamic website-link codes. They appear on the Codes page like any other.

QR Codes [Codes](#) [New QR code](#) [Campaigns](#) [Link pages](#) [Bulk](#) [Designs](#) [Export scans](#) [Users](#) [Help](#) [Sign out \(admin\)](#)

Bulk QR codes

▼ **What is this? How do I use it?**

What it is. Makes many tracked QR codes at once from a spreadsheet: one code for each row, returned as a ZIP of pictures plus a list of their addresses.

How to use it. Save your spreadsheet as CSV with the headings label and url (and optionally campaign), upload it, choose the options and press the button. Either every row is made or none is. [Read more in Help](#)

What is tracked. Making codes in bulk is written to the activity log (who, and how many). Each code then records scans like any dynamic code. [Full list](#)

Upload a CSV and get one tracked QR code per row, as a ZIP of images plus a CSV listing each code's address. Either every row is created or none is.

CSV file (first row must be headers: `label,url` and optionally `campaign`)

No file chosen

Campaign for rows that do not have one

Tracking window **Images**

90 days SVG only (up to 1000 rows, best for print)

Design

Plain black and white

Save designs from the New QR code form, then use them here.

Error correction

M

Figure 14. Bulk: one code per row of a CSV, returned as a ZIP.

19. Link pages (like Linktree)

What it is. A *link page* is a web page, hosted here, that gathers all of a company's links in one place: website, social media, email, phone. It carries the company's logo and a theme, works well on a phone, and counts how many people open it and which buttons they press. Open **Link pages** in the menu.

Use it where you can only give one address: a social media profile, an email signature, a business card, a poster. Or make a QR code that opens it (see below).

Making a page

1. Press **New link page**. To save time, use **Start from an example** on the Link pages page: it fills in a page for Blake UK, VisionPlus or Solwise. **The example addresses are placeholders: check every one before you publish.**
2. **Company.** Click Blake UK, VisionPlus or Solwise. This sets the logo and the company's colours.
3. **Theme.** Click one and watch the preview:
 - **Midnight:** deep navy, glowing curves in the accent colour, glass-style buttons with round icon badges and a row of social tiles at the bottom.
 - **Daylight:** light and clean, white buttons on a soft background, the company colour for the icons.
 - **Bold:** a dark page tinted with the company colour, with solid, company-coloured buttons.

Dark themes use the company's logo made for dark backgrounds; Daylight uses the one for light backgrounds. You can change theme at any time without losing anything.

4. **Accent colour.** By default the page uses the company's own colour. To use a different one, untick *Use the company's own colour* and pick one. If it would be hard to read on that theme (for example navy on Midnight), the form explains and refuses it.
5. **The page.** The *Name* is just for you. The *Page address* is the part after `/1/` in the web address; leave it empty to use the name. Lower-case letters, numbers and dashes only. The *Heading* appears under the logo ("Official Links" if left empty) and the *Subheading* is optional. Two tick boxes choose whether each button shows its web address underneath and whether the social icons row appears.
6. **Buttons.** For each button give a *Title* and an *Address*:
 - A web address starting `https://` opens that page.
 - `mailto:name@example.com` starts an email.
 - `tel:+441142235000` offers to call that number.

The *Icon* is chosen from the address (Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, TikTok, YouTube, X, Pinterest, WhatsApp, email, phone, location, or a globe) unless you pick another. *Small text* replaces the address shown underneath. Use the arrows to move a button up or down and the cross to remove it. Empty rows are ignored. A page can have up to 30 buttons. Use *Add another button* for more rows.
7. **Live preview.** The phone beside the form shows your page as it is right now, including things you have not saved. Buttons in the preview open in a new tab. Nothing is published or counted until you press **Create page** (or **Save changes**).

Sharing it, and a QR code for it

- After saving, the page's own screen shows its public address with a *Copy* button. Anyone can open it; no sign-in is needed.
- Press **Make a QR code for this page**. This makes a normal, tracked QR code (see [Making a QR code](#)) in the company's colour with the words "SCAN FOR OUR LINKS". Use *Edit* on that code to change its colours, frame or logo, then download it as usual. You can make as many as you like, for example one for a poster and one for a leaflet, and give each its own campaign.
- Visits that arrive through a QR code are counted separately as *via a QR code*.

Views or clicks: what is the difference?

A **view** is someone opening the page. A **click** is someone pressing a button on it. They count different things, so the two numbers are not the same and you should not expect them to match.

	Views	Button clicks
What it counts	Each time the page is opened	Each press of a web button on the page
One person can make	Many: a reload or a return visit counts again. <i>Unique visitors</i> counts them once a day.	Many (several buttons, or one button twice), or none at all
Email and phone buttons	Not applicable	Cannot be counted: they open the visitor's own app directly
Bots and link previews	Left out	Left out
Where you see it	Views, Unique visitors, Via a QR code, Views over time	Button clicks, Pressed a button, Clicks on each button

An example. Your poster has a QR code that opens the page, and 100 people scan it. The code shows *100 scans*. The page shows *100 views*, all marked via a QR code. Sixty of them press at least one button and some press two, so the page shows *85 button clicks* and *60% pressed a button*. Views tell you how many people arrived; clicks tell you what they did next.

Scans, views and clicks. A *scan* belongs to a QR code (the Codes screen). A *view* and a *click* belong to a link page. When a QR code opens a link page, one scan normally leads to one view, and then perhaps some clicks. The percentage is of visitors, not of clicks, so it cannot go above 100% however many buttons people press.

Reading the statistics

- **Views:** how many times the page was opened. **Unique visitors:** each person once a day. **Via a QR code:** views that came from one of this page's QR codes. **Button clicks:** how many times a web button was pressed. **Pressed a button:** the share of unique visitors who pressed at least one button (never more than 100%). The next part explains the difference between views and clicks.
- **Views over time:** a chart by day (UK time) for the last 30 days.
- **Clicks on each button:** which links people use, with the time of the last click. Email and phone buttons open the visitor's own app directly, so their taps cannot be counted.
- Boxes below show where views came from (QR code or a direct link), device, operating system, language, country and referring site. Bots, such as link previews in chat apps, are left out.

Changing, switching off and deleting

- **Edit** changes anything. Buttons you keep stay the same button, so their click history is kept. A button you remove takes its own history with it from the list.
- **Changing the page address:** QR codes made with *Make a QR code for this page* follow the page to its new address automatically. Links you shared anywhere else (a social profile, an email, a printed address) stop working, so avoid changing it once a page is out.
- **Switch off** takes the page down without deleting it: visitors see "Page not found". **Switch on** brings it back.
- **Delete** removes the page and its statistics for good. Codes that pointed at it keep working but lead to "Page not found".

Good to know

- Link pages follow the same privacy rules as QR codes (see [What is tracked](#)): no names, no cookies, and the visitor's address is only stored in a scrambled, daily-changing form. Records are deleted after the retention period.
- Pages are marked so that search engines do not list them.
- The three companies and their logos are built in. Adding a fourth company is a small change for a developer (a logo and a colour).
- Logos and social icons are used only to identify the company and the services you link to.

QR Codes Codes New QR code Campaigns Link pages Bulk Designs Export scans Users Help Sign out (admin) 

Edit link page

▼ What is this? How do I use it?

What it is. Where you build a link page: choose the company and theme, write the heading, and list the buttons. The phone on the right is a live preview.

How to use it. Work down the page. Everything you change shows in the preview straight away, but nothing is published until you press the button at the bottom. [Read more in Help](#)

What is tracked. Nothing is recorded while you edit or use the preview. Saving is written to the activity log. [Full list](#)

1. Company

What it is. Whose page this is. It sets the logo and the company's colours. **How to use it.** Click one.

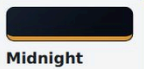
 Blake UK

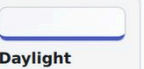
 VisionPlus

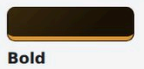
 Solwise

2. Theme

What it is. The look of the page: layout, background and button style. **How to use it.** Click one and watch the preview change. You can switch at any time. [Help](#)

 **Midnight**
Deep navy with glowing accent curves, glass

 **Daylight**
Clean and light: white buttons on a soft

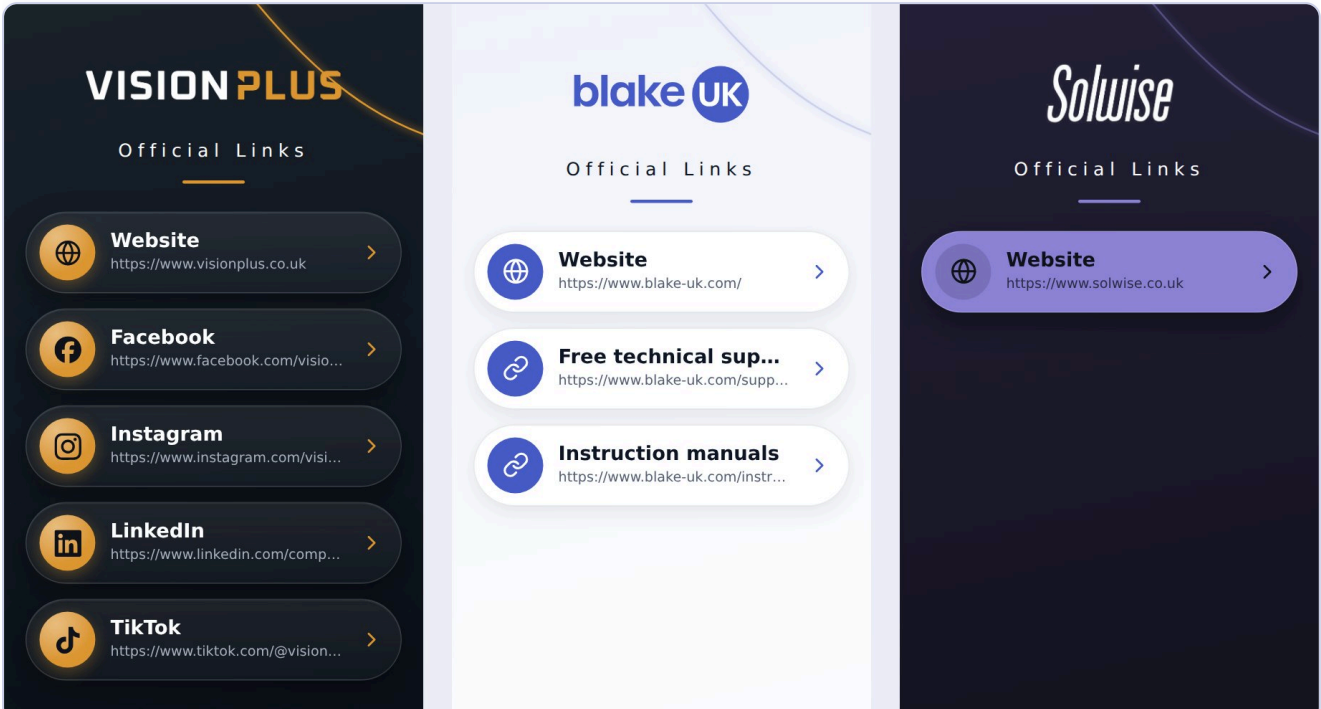
 **Bold**
A dark page tinted with the brand colour and

Live preview

Shows your choices as you make them. Buttons open in a new tab.



Figure 15. The link page editor: company, theme, page details and buttons, with a live preview.



The image shows three side-by-side link page previews. Each page has a header with the company logo and the text 'Official Links'. Below the header are several buttons with icons and text, each followed by a right-pointing arrow. The first page is for VisionPlus (Midnight theme) and shows buttons for Website, Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, and TikTok. The second page is for Blake UK (Daylight theme) and shows buttons for Website, Free technical support, and Instruction manuals. The third page is for Solwise (Bold theme) and shows a button for Website.

Figure 16. The same engine, three companies, three themes: VisionPlus (Midnight), Blake UK (Daylight), Solwise (Bold).

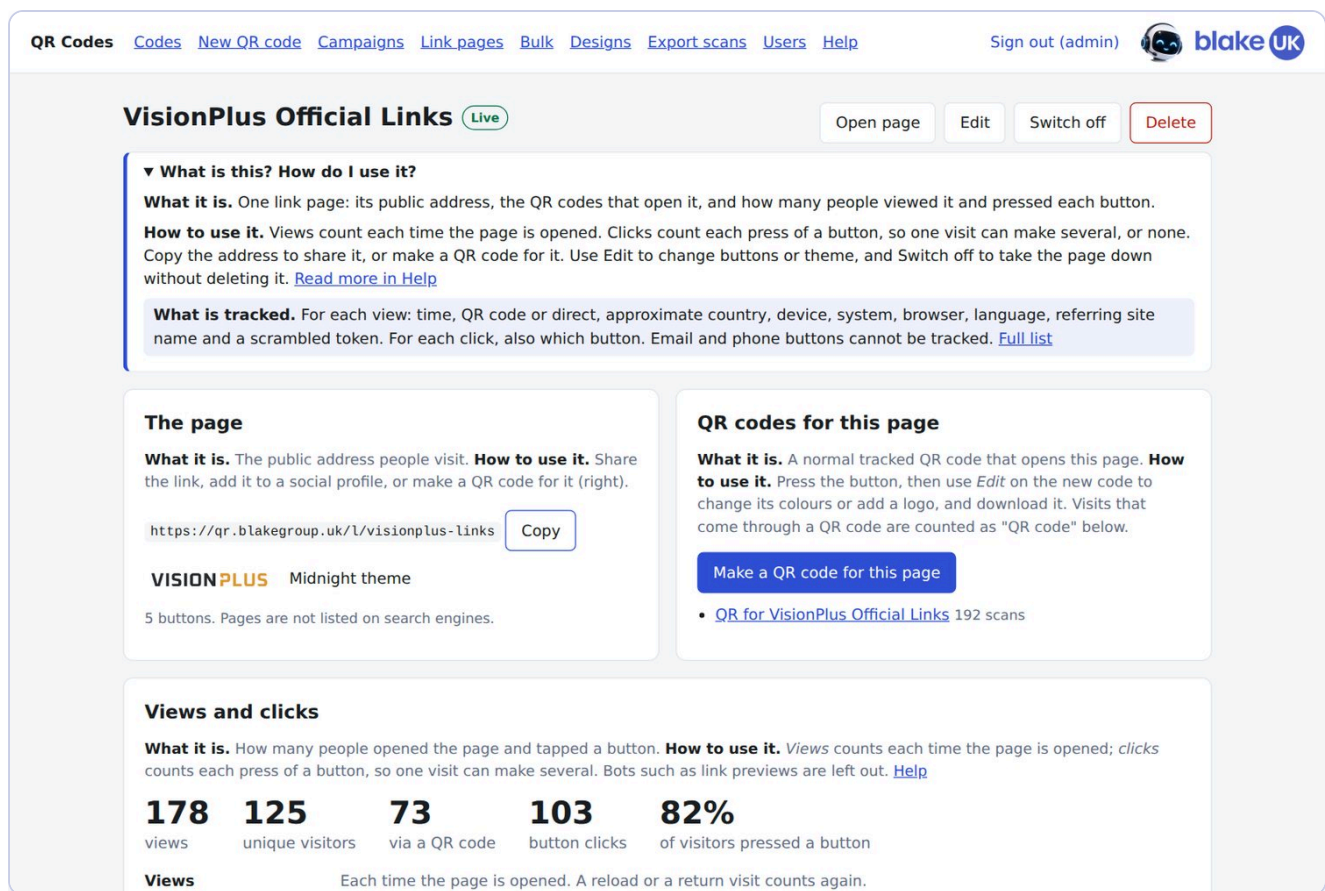


Figure 17. A link page's statistics: views, QR visits, clicks per button.

20. Users and roles

What it is. The people who can sign in. Open **Users** in the menu.

- **Roles.** An *admin* can do everything, including managing users. A *member* can make and manage QR codes, campaigns and designs and read all the statistics, but cannot manage users.
- **Add a user.** Enter a user name (3 to 32 letters, numbers, dots, dashes or underscores), choose a role, and either type a temporary password (at least 12 characters) or leave it blank to have one generated. A generated password is shown **once** on the screen: copy it and pass it to the person securely. The new person must choose their own password when they first sign in.
- **Reset a password.** Press *Reset password* next to the person (blank for a generated one). They are signed out everywhere, their old password stops working, and they must choose a new one at next sign-in. Use this for forgotten passwords.
- **Change a role.** Pick the role and press Save. The person is signed out so the change takes effect cleanly.
- **Remove a user.** Press Remove and confirm. They are signed out at once and can no longer sign in. QR codes they made stay.
- **Safety rules.** You cannot remove yourself, and the last admin can never be removed or made a member, so the system can never be left with nobody in charge.
- **Recent activity** lists who did what and when (creating codes, adding users, resetting passwords, saving designs...). It never records passwords.

QR Codes [Codes](#) [New QR code](#) [Campaigns](#) [Link pages](#) [Bulk](#) [Designs](#) [Export scans](#) [Users](#) [Help](#) [Sign out \(admin\)](#) 

Users

▼ **What is this? How do I use it?**

What it is. The people who can sign in to this system. Admins can manage QR codes and people; members can manage QR codes only.

How to use it. Add a person with a name, a role and a temporary password (or leave it blank to have one made). Use Reset password if someone is locked out. The activity log shows who did what. [Read more in Help](#)

What is tracked. Adding, removing, role changes and password resets are written to the activity log below (who, what, when, never a password). Sign-in attempts are kept in scrambled form for 24 hours to stop password guessing. [Full list](#)

Admins can do everything, including managing users. Members can create and manage QR codes and see statistics, but cannot manage users.

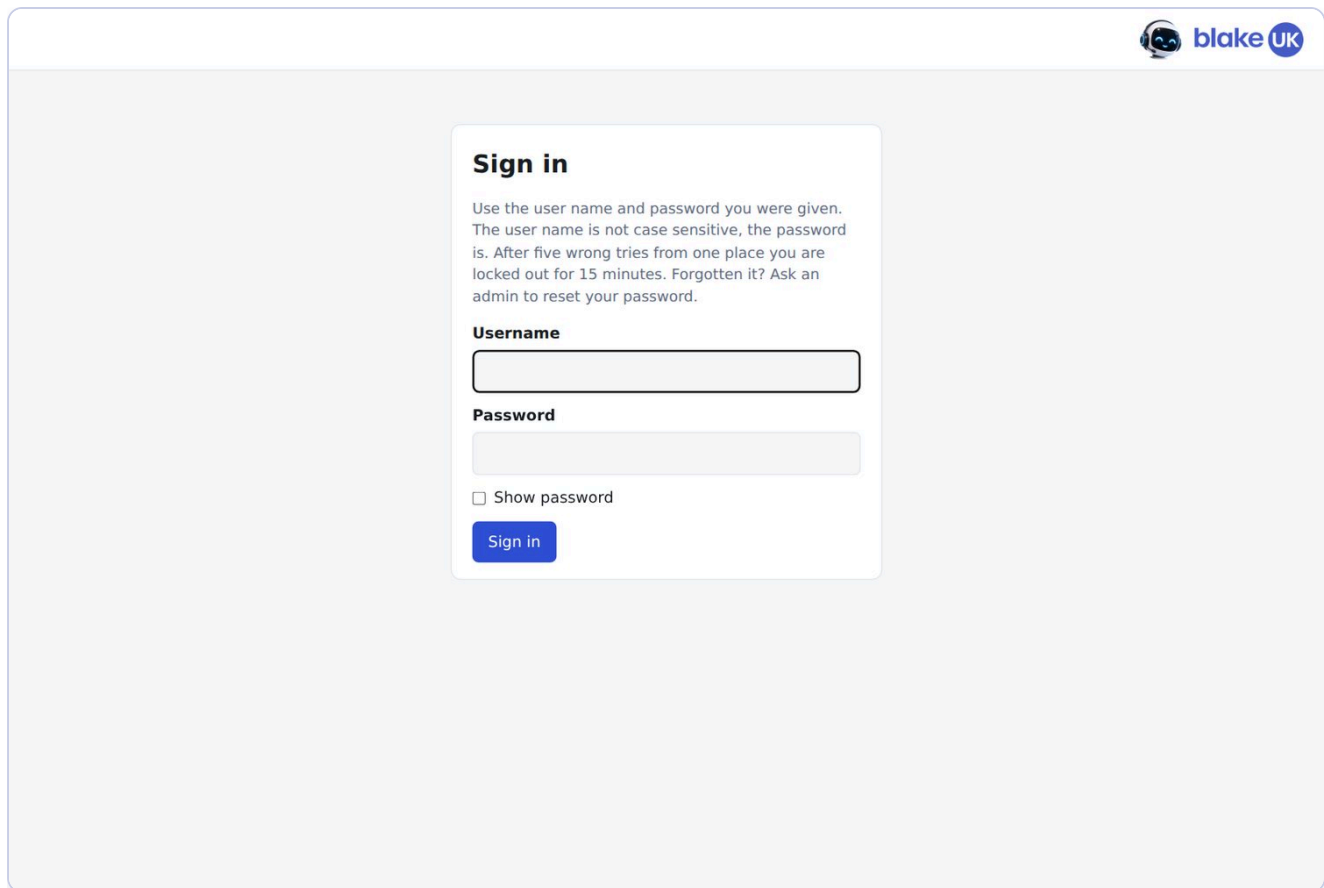
USER	ROLE	STATUS	CREATED	ACTIONS
admin You	Admin Save	active 2 signed in	09 Oct 2026 12:30	new temporary password (blank = get Reset password
sales	Member Save	Must Change Password	09 Oct 2026 12:30	new temporary password (blank = get Reset password Remove
support	Member Save	Must Change Password	09 Oct 2026 12:30	new temporary password (blank = get Reset password Remove

Add a user

Figure 18. Users: add people, change roles, reset passwords, and the activity log.

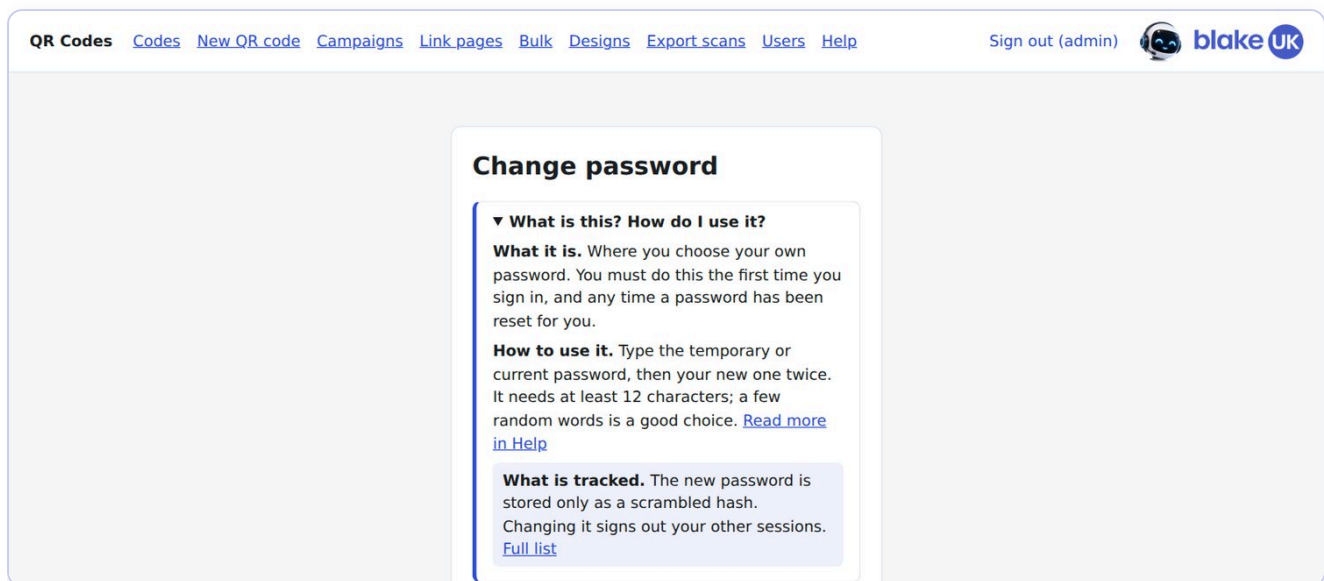
21. Your account: signing in and your password

- **Signing in.** The user name is not case sensitive; the password is. After **five wrong tries within 15 minutes** from one place you are locked out for 15 minutes; waiting is enough, and an admin can reset your password if you have forgotten it.
- **First sign-in.** You are taken straight to *Change password*. Enter the temporary password, then your own new one twice. It must be at least 12 characters (up to 72); three or four random words is easy to remember and strong. A *Show passwords* tick lets you check what you typed.
- **Changing your password later.** You can open the same page again from the address `/admin/password`. Changing it signs out your other sessions.
- **If every admin is locked out or has forgotten their password.** Another admin can reset it from the Users page. If nobody can sign in, whoever looks after the server can run *Reset a QR tracker password* (a GitHub Actions workflow) or `qrtrack resetpassword NAME` on the server. It prints a one-time temporary password, forces a change at next sign-in, signs that user out everywhere and clears all lockouts.
- **Staying signed in.** You are signed out after 12 hours of inactivity, and in any case after 7 days.
- **Signing out.** Use *Sign out* at the top, especially on a shared computer.



The screenshot shows the Blake UK sign-in page. At the top right is the Blake UK logo. The main content is a white box with a light blue border. Inside, the title "Sign in" is in bold. Below it is a paragraph of instructions: "Use the user name and password you were given. The user name is not case sensitive, the password is. After five wrong tries from one place you are locked out for 15 minutes. Forgotten it? Ask an admin to reset your password." There are two input fields: "Username" and "Password". Below the password field is a checkbox labeled "Show password". At the bottom of the box is a blue "Sign in" button.

Figure 19. The sign-in page.



The screenshot shows the Blake UK "Change password" page. At the top is a navigation bar with links: "QR Codes", "Codes", "New QR code", "Campaigns", "Link pages", "Bulk", "Designs", "Export scans", "Users", and "Help". On the right of the navigation bar is a "Sign out (admin)" link and the Blake UK logo. The main content is a white box with a light blue border. Inside, the title "Change password" is in bold. Below it is a section titled "▼ What is this? How do I use it?". This section contains three paragraphs: "What it is." (explaining when to change a password), "How to use it." (explaining the requirements for a new password and providing a link to "Read more in Help"), and "What is tracked." (explaining how the password is stored and the effect of changing it, with a link to "Full list").

Figure 20. Choosing your own password.

22. Limits at a glance

What it is. The sizes and numbers the system enforces, in one place.

Thing	Limit
QR code name	100 characters
Campaign name	60 characters
Web address	2,048 characters; must start <code>http://</code> or <code>https://</code>
Static code content	About 900 bytes (less with a logo); plain text up to 800 characters
Scan limit on a code	0 (none) up to 10,000,000
Smart routing rules	Up to 5 per code, first match wins
Password on a code	4 to 72 characters; six wrong guesses a minute per visitor
Text under a QR code (frame)	24 characters
Logo	PNG, JPEG or GIF, up to 1 MB and 4,000 pixels each way; stored at no more than 256 pixels
Saved design name	60 characters
PNG downloads	256, 512 or 1,024 pixels wide, or SVG
Bulk (CSV)	File up to 1 MB; up to 1,000 rows as SVG, 250 with PNG
Link page address	3 to 40 characters: lower-case letters, numbers, dashes
Link page name / heading / subheading	100 / 80 / 160 characters
Link page buttons	Up to 30 per page; title 60 characters, small text 80
Visitors	30 requests a minute per visitor to tracking addresses and link pages
User name / password	3 to 32 characters / at least 12 and no more than 72
Sign-in logout	5 wrong tries within 15 minutes locks that place out for 15 minutes
Sessions	Signed out after 12 hours without use, and after 7 days at most
Lists	25 codes per page; 50 scans per page; the ten most common values in each breakdown
Charts	By the hour when the tracking window is under 3 days, otherwise by the day (up to 400 days)
Records kept	365 days for scans, link page views and the activity log; 24 hours for sign-in attempts

23. Troubleshooting and questions

My printed code will not scan.

Check the size (at least about 2 cm), the blank border, and the contrast (dark on light). Scan it from different distances with two phones. Try error correction H and a simpler design (square dots, no logo). For a dynamic code, check the code is not disabled and its window has not ended with *show expired page*.

The form says the design is "too close to the background".

The code colour is too pale or too similar to the background. Choose a darker code colour or a lighter background.

"That is too long to fit in a QR code."

A static code holds its content directly, so very long text or a big contact card does not fit. Shorten it, or make it a dynamic code (which only holds a short address).

I want to change where a printed code goes.

Only dynamic codes can be changed. Open it, press Edit and change the address. A static code can never be changed; make a new one.

I made a static code but want tracking.

That is not possible. Make a new dynamic code and use that one from now on.

The scan count looks too low.

Only people are counted, and only while the window is active. Bots, link previews and scans before the start date are not counted. Check the dates, press *Include bots* to see the robots, and remember a scan limit stops counting.

The scan count looks too high.

Several people may be scanning, and *All scans* counts repeat visits by the same person. Look at *Unique* for different visitors.

The town is wrong.

Towns are estimates from the visitor's internet address. Mobile networks and VPNs often show the wrong one. Use country, and treat regions and towns as a guide.

I cannot sign in.

Check Caps Lock (the password is case sensitive), try again with the *Show password* tick if available, and wait 15 minutes if you have had five wrong tries. If you still cannot, ask an admin to reset your password.

The page says "Admins only".

You are signed in as a member. Ask an admin if you need a user managed.

The bulk upload failed.

Read the list: it names the spreadsheet row and the problem. Check the headings are exactly `label` and `url`, that every address starts with `https://`, and that the file is saved as CSV.

I deleted a code by mistake.

It cannot be undone. A dynamic code that was printed will now show "Link not found". Make a new one and, if you still have the old printed copies, replace them.

Who can see my scans?

Everyone who is signed in, admins and members. Visitors never can. See [What is tracked](#).

Can I delete one person's scan?

No. Scans carry no name or address, so one person's cannot be picked out. Deleting a QR code or link page deletes all its records, and everything is removed automatically after the retention period.

Where do I find the scans in a spreadsheet?

On a code's page press *Export CSV*, or press *Export scans* in the menu for every code.

24. What this system does not do

So you are not looking for something that is not there:

- It does not host files or general web pages: there is no PDF, MP3, video, menu or landing-page code. The only hosted pages are [Link pages](#). To send people to a PDF or video, use *Website link* to point at one that already lives on blake-uk.com or YouTube.
- It does not run advertising or retargeting pixels (Google Tag Manager, Facebook pixel), which would slow every scan and need a cookie banner.
- It has no public interface for other software yet, no two-factor sign-in, and no email alerts.
- Campaigns are a single list, not folders.
- Link pages count views and button clicks but are not exported to CSV, and a page cannot yet be copied to start a new one.

25. Glossary

Bot

A program, not a person, that visits addresses automatically.

Button click

One press of a web button on a link page. One visit can make several, or none.

Campaign

A label for where a code is used.

CSV

A plain spreadsheet file that Excel and Google Sheets can open and save.

Dynamic code

A tracked code whose destination can be changed.

Error correction

Extra information in the code that lets it scan even when damaged.

PNG

A common picture format with a fixed number of pixels.

Quiet zone

The blank border round a code. Scanners need it.

Referrer

The site or app a visitor came from.

Scan

One person scanning a dynamic QR code. Counted on the code, not on a link page.

Static code

An untracked code that holds its content itself.

SVG

A picture format that can be made any size without going blurry.

Tracking address

The short web address inside a dynamic code.

Unique visitor

A person counted once in a 24-hour period.

View

One opening of a link page. A reload or return visit counts again; Unique visitors counts a person once a day.

Missing something? Ask Max: the Max button at the top right of every page brings you back here.

Appendix A. QR code types at a glance

Static codes hold their content and are never tracked. Dynamic codes go through the system, can be changed later, and are tracked. Section 6 explains what to enter for each type.

Type	Static	Dynamic	What it does
Website link	✓	✓	Open any web page.
Google Form	✓	✓	Open a survey or form.
Google review	✓	✓	Ask for a review on Google.
App stores	–	✓	One code, the right store: iPhones go to the App Store, Android to Google Play.
Smart URL	–	✓	Send people to different pages by device, system, language or country.
Contact card (vCard)	✓	✓	Save a contact to the phone's address book.
Email	✓	–	Start an email to an address.
SMS text message	✓	–	Start a text message.
Phone call	✓	–	Dial a number.
WhatsApp	✓	✓	Open a WhatsApp chat, optionally with a message ready to send.
Facebook	✓	✓	Send people to your Facebook page, profile or post.
Instagram	✓	✓	Send people to your Instagram page, profile or post.
YouTube	✓	✓	Send people to your YouTube page, profile or post.
TikTok	✓	✓	Send people to your TikTok page, profile or post.
X (Twitter)	✓	✓	Send people to your X (Twitter) page, profile or post.
Pinterest	✓	✓	Send people to your Pinterest page, profile or post.
LinkedIn	✓	✓	Send people to your LinkedIn page, profile or post.
Location	✓	✓	Show a place on the map.
Calendar event	✓	✓	Add an event to the phone's calendar.
Wi-Fi network	✓	–	Let guests join Wi-Fi by scanning. Static only: it has to work before they are online.
Plain text	✓	–	Show a short piece of text.

Appendix B. Where to find things in the menu

Menu item	What it opens	Section
Codes	The list of every QR code	2
New QR code	Choose static or dynamic, then a type, then the form	3, 5

Menu item	What it opens	Section
Campaigns	Totals for each campaign	16
Link pages	Build and measure Linktree-style pages	19
Bulk	Many codes from one CSV	18
Designs	Saved looks, and the New design page	8
Export scans	Every scan as a CSV	15
Users (admins)	People, roles, passwords, activity log	20
Help	This material on screen, plus the PDF download	All
Sign out , top right	Ends your session. Max opens Help; the Blake UK logo opens blake-uk.com	21

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Blake UK Group

This manual describes the QR Codes and Link Pages system at qr.blakegroup.uk.
For anything not covered here, use the Help page in the system or ask your administrator.